

Oruma — embedded business banking for vertical software platforms

The Problem

A software platform serving 8,000 restaurants already knows their revenue, their payroll and their supplier payments. It cannot offer them a bank account, because doing so means a sponsor bank relationship, a compliance function, a ledger and eighteen months of work that has nothing to do with restaurants.

So the restaurant keeps its account somewhere else, the platform keeps none of the deposit economics, and the data that would make underwriting trivial sits unused on both sides.

Our Solution

Oruma gives vertical software platforms a full business banking stack through an API: accounts, cards, payments, and a ledger that reconciles to the cent.

A platform integrates in roughly six weeks and launches banking under its own brand. We handle the sponsor bank relationship, KYB, transaction monitoring and the regulatory reporting. The platform handles its customers, which is the part it is good at.

The Market

There are roughly 4,300 vertical software platforms in North America with more than 1,000 business customers each. Embedded finance revenue in the segment is estimated at \$18B by 2030.

The thesis is not new and the market knows it. What has changed is that sponsor bank capacity tightened sharply after the 2023–2024 enforcement wave, which raised the barrier for anyone starting now and consolidated volume onto providers already live.

Competition

Three well-funded providers serve this market, two of them with larger platform customers than ours. Several platforms build in-house once they pass a certain scale, which is a real and recurring source of churn in this business.

Our position is speed to launch and a ledger that reconciles without a monthly manual exercise, which sounds unglamorous and is the reason two of our customers switched to us.

The Team

Daniel Okonkwo spent five years in payments operations at a business banking provider and ran its sponsor bank relationships. Lea Brandt was an engineering manager on a core ledger system.

Twenty-two people, six of them in compliance.

Traction

- 14 platforms live, 6 more in integration
- \$6.2M annualised revenue, up 3.1x year on year
- \$410M in annualised payment volume
- 31,000 end business accounts
- no platform has churned

The growth is genuine and it is accelerating. Three of the fourteen went live in the last quarter.

Business Model

We take interchange on card spend, a share of net interest on deposits, and a platform fee of \$3,000 to \$9,000 a month.

Two things about that revenue need stating plainly.

First, 78% of our volume clears through a single sponsor bank. We have a second relationship signed but not yet live, and migrating volume between sponsors is a six-month exercise that our platform customers would feel.

Second, one platform accounts for 64% of revenue. Its contract runs to 2028 with a 90-day termination clause, and it has an internal team that has started scoping a build.

Both risks are known to us and neither is solved.

Go-To-Market

Direct sales to platform product leaders, plus referrals from the vertical SaaS investors who sit on several of their boards.

Funding

We are raising \$25M to bring the second sponsor live, reduce the concentration, and win the mid-sized platforms where no single customer can be 64% of anything.